

NATESAN MURUGHASAN

60, BUSINESSMAN
CHAIRMAN, RAJATHI GROUP
INITIAL INVESTMENT IN 1974 Rs 750
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 600 crore

BEEN THERE, DONE THAT

He stitched socks and worked as an office attendant in a company in Nagapattinam, a small town in Tamil Nadu. Thirty years and many success stories later, Natesan Murughasan, 60, is the chairman of Rajathi Group of Companies, a large conglomerate of diversified interests in international trade, bio-technology and the hospitality industry. "I believe in the Gita and do

If this wasn't enough, Murughasan explored iron ore, bio-technology, and realty as well. He started Rajathi Biotech Private Limited in 2006, a company that pioneers in the field of inoculants, in major demand globally. Despite a hectic routine, a morning walk to the beach followed by a rigorous workout is a must for him. Though he vouches for simplicity, he's also the proud owner of 10 cars, his favourite

H.K. RAJASHEKAR



SUCCESS MANTRA

Don't be sentimental
in business

one REGRET

Not having studied after
Class 10. But he keeps
updating his knowledge.

on his ATTITUDE

Describes himself as a
risk-taker by nature

my duty without thinking of the results. I'm a risk-taker by nature," says Murghasan.

The risk-taking has paid off. In 1974, Murughasan, who lives in Chennai, started a small agro-based business with just Rs 750. It flourished into an export business with a turnover of Rs 600 crore. His stint in exports began with onions, a perishable item generally avoided by exporters. The self-confessed adventurer took the plunge. Today his company accounts for 60 per cent of India's onion exports to Asian countries. He also exports sesame seeds, sugar, maize, chillies and rice.

being the Lamborghini and BMW 7 series.

Like most achievers, Murughasan too attributes his success to his friends. To express his gratitude to his friend, Gulam Dastager who helped him financially, he named his corporate office building Gulam Square. Though Murughasan is a leading businessman today, he regrets not studying further. To make up for it, he instituted a scholarship for the best outgoing student of St. Anthony's School, his alma mater in Dindugal, Madurai district. Who knows? He might be a Murghasan in the making.

by Banumathi Krishnaswamy

**THE RAJATHI GROUP
HAS FORAYED INTO
THE HOSPITALITY**

**SECTOR WITH
BREEZE HOTEL
IN CHENNAI.**

**MURUGHASAN
PLANS TO OPEN
15 HOTELS BY
2012 WITH AN
INVESTMENT
OF RS 500 CRORE.**